Hermes Agent x Apertus for privacy-conscious email marketing

Technical brief · Hack Apertus Online Hackathon · Track 2B

Project: Nick Menzi · Status: local fictional no-send demonstrator

Purpose

A Docker-runnable Hermes demonstrator for controlled creation and review of fictional email drafts for Onlineshop Demo AG. Email automation can mix recipient context, sensitive data, drafting and sending. This project separates those steps into fictional data, minimised context, a local review queue and a no-send boundary.

Result

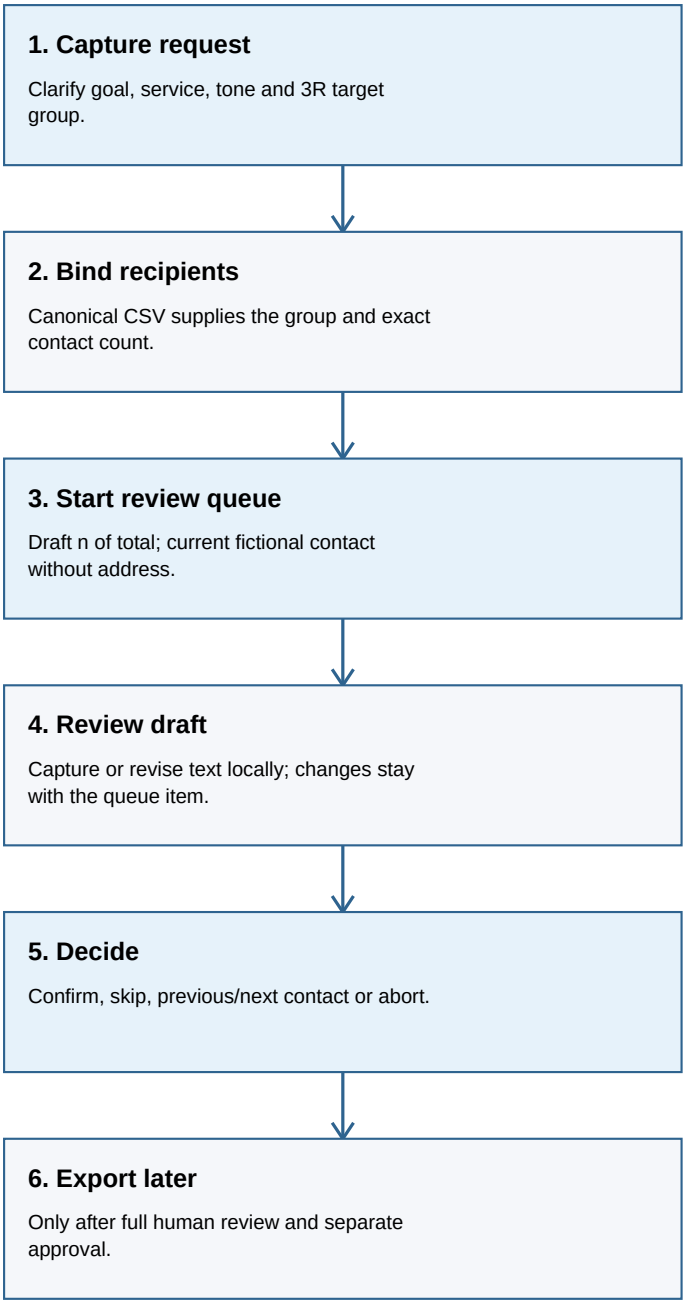
- Versioned agent profile and controlled transfer to an isolated local runtime.
- One canonical fictional 3R contact source: 50 contacts - 17 recruit, 17 retain, 16 recover.
- Deterministic per-contact review queue with previous/next, local review, confirmation, skip and abort.
- No email address in the review view; no SMTP, CRM, webhook, sending or automatic export.

Safe default state

Every queue item remains draft_only and no_send. A confirmed draft is neither sent nor delivered. No real contact or customer data is part of this demo.

Architecture and controlled workflow

Free TUI conversation supports drafting. The local review queue controls recipient selection and order.



What is intentionally absent

No sending adapter, SMTP, CRM, newsletter job or messaging gateway. The queue only manages local draft and review states.

Data and safety boundaries

Fictional data basis

The visible source data/demo_contacts_3r.csv contains only contacts marked fictional_demo_only. Every address ends in @example.invalid. The technical fixture under tests/fixtures/ is separate and is not a second visible demo source.

Review-queue minimisation

Displayed fields

Contact ID, first and last name, company, language, 3R category, lifecycle stage, interest and tags.

Excluded

Email address, internal notes, credentials, real customer data and any sending or delivery information.

Evidence-based limits

- The model endpoint is not supplied or verified by this repository.
- A live model call was not part of the current verification.
- The real Docker TUI must run on an authorised host; the Docker socket was unavailable in the automation environment.
- A contact in the CSV does not grant delivery permission - the demo has no sender.

Core principle

A plausible model response is never treated as a company fact. Offers, discounts, deadlines, delivery times or customer attributes must come from operator input or be explicitly labelled as a suggestion.

Verification, reproducibility and next step

Verified status

43/43 offline tests passed: CSV structure and 3R counts, data minimisation, no-send state, queue navigation, local draft confirmation, profile application, plugin import and Docker Compose configuration.

Reproducible sequence

1. make test - run offline checks without a model call.
2. make profile-apply - transfer the versioned profile to the local runtime.
3. From track_2b/, run make run; see README.md for Docker setup and local .env configuration.
4. View a fictional 3R group and start a per-contact review queue.

Open limitation

Outside the controlled queue path, natural model conversation can still formulate unsuitable business details. The review queue therefore does not replace further TUI work; it already safeguards recipient selection, ordering and local review state.

Next useful increment

Embed the queue directly in the normal TUI dialog: before every concrete draft, bind the recipient group from the CSV, state the exact count and then use the current review contact. Real data imports, sending, CRM and messaging remain outside this demonstrator.

Decision statement

The Hackathon demo is traceable and safely bounded. A production solution would require real consent and suppression checks, authenticated roles, a separately authorised sending adapter, and new privacy and security approval.